

Performance

Camera...? One word—K790i. This is perhaps the best 3.2 megapixel camera out there (neck and neck with the N73's camera). Brilliant image quality, and colours are reasonably neutral, with only a slight hint of red. All this at default settings; we could have seen better results with a little tweaking, but we reminded ourselves that this wasn't a digital camera test. The other cameras are mostly mediocre, with the Sony Ericssons sporting the best image capture hardware. The only possible gripe against the K790i is the painful SIM removal. To be sure, not many users would keep swapping SIMs, so this shouldn't sway you.

The Nokia N70 performed surprisingly badly in the signal quality tests—we even got a couple of disconnected calls. Voice quality wasn't bad, but the call getting disconnected wasn't fun. This happened in zone 1; zone 2 was a little reassuring, but still by far the worst of the phones. Hands-free quality was, strangely, the best in the test.

Coming to PMP capabilities, we were surprised to see the "best sounding as an MP3 player" award going to a non-Walkman phone. In fact, the K790i pushed away from all its Walkman siblings to grab the accolades here. It's just limited by the mediocre headphones.

Nokia's 5700 did well in the music test, aided by good headphones of the supra-aural type. We also liked the concept of the wireless earphones on the ROKR E6. While these sound good, they are a little uncomfortable. People with smaller ear canals, watch out!

Our Conclusion

Sony Ericsson's K790i is simply unbeatable—an excellent camera, great music quality, an excellent screen to add to a good keypad, and excellent joystick. A no-brainer—the *Digit* Best Buy Gold to this excellent all-rounder. Highly recommended if you have a budget of rupees 16,000.

The *Digit* Best Silver award has been bagged by **Nokia's 5700 Xpress Music**, we declare. Good music quality, a good screen, and nifty MP3 buttons! Do pad up your thumb before touching the joypad though!

If you want something slim yet very inconspicuous looking, consider SE's W880i. Just remember, you'll pay a hefty premium for the features. If you're OK with something just a little less slim, go with the SE W610i—it's a little flashy (lots of orange). Both these phones performed well overall. Remember, these should only be your choice if you absolutely do not like

the looks of the K790i. However, this would be a rare event indeed, and most users will just blindly buy the K790i—superlative choice really...

Nokia's 5700 is not an option—not with the K790i around in a similar price range.

The Motorola ROKR E6 is another phone that grabs attention. A touchscreen and a Bluetooth headset (which costs Rs 3,000 extra), this is something for those who like to flash their handsets around.

Super, Smart, Sexy

(Above Rs 20,000)

Features

The **LG KG-920** stands out here—very gimmicky-looking, with an array of buttons sticking out from nearly every angle. A lot of buttons usually spells ergonomics with a capital E. The camera button is beautiful—soft click (less chances of shaking) with great feedback; not so the other buttons. The joypad is hard on the fingers owing to sharp ridges. The tiny keypad is a pain for all except the tiniest fingers. The sharp screen is a plus.

The **Sony Ericsson W950i** is basically an M600 in a different garb—the Walkman series colour tones are evident, and the QWERTY is absent. The diaphragm type keys work well, but longevity is an issue with such keypads—you can't replace the keys. A brilliant screen dominates the W950i. The stylus gets slippery in its sheath after a few weeks, though.

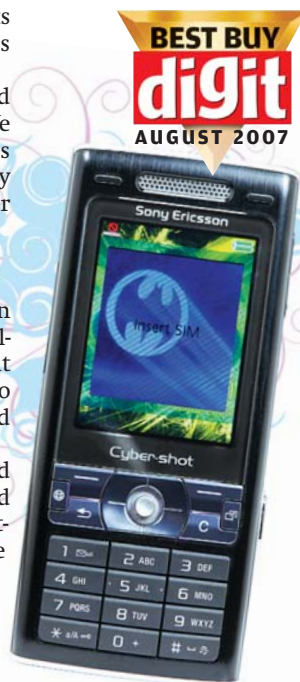
The **Nokia N73 Music Edition** is a weirdly long phone. Wonder why so much of space was wasted below the gorgeous screen! A larger keypad would have been appreciated. Feedback is good, though, but the joypad is once again a pain. No such ergonomic issues on the other Nokias, though. The **N80** feels a little chunky and boasts of a surprisingly high resolution screen (352 x 416) pixels. We'd like to have seen a larger screen though—just not enough real-estate to take advantage of all those pixels! The N73ME is all black, and comes with a 2 GB memory card. Nokia's POP to 3.5 mm converter is bundled too—this accessory costs Rs 1,000 all by itself.

The **N95** is superb in every way except one: its slider isn't tactile, and feels tacky. Whether this is intentional or not we don't know, but extra friction should affect life, in our opinion. The display's absolutely superb, and with 2.6 inches displaying 16 million colours, everything looks clear, crisp, and rich... The phone also has GPS inbuilt; although Nokia's maps are currently rudimentary, this can only get better.

Performance

We spent a lot of time with the N73ME, having used the N73 before this. The inbuilt speakers are powerful—more so than those on the N95. Music quality is very good, with higher volumes than those on the SE K790i. Clarity is good, but the midtones sound a little recessed. A good set of earplugs will get the most out of this phone.

The N95 has a superlative camera, a little better than that on the LG KG920, which



Sony Ericsson K790i
Awesome camera, great music...

Contact Sheet		Cellphone Test
Brand	Company	Web Site
ASUS	ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.	www.in.asus.com
BenQ-Siemens	BenQ India Pvt. Ltd.	benq.co.in
HP	Hewlett Packard India Pvt. Ltd.	www.hp.com
HTC	Dopod Communication (India) Pvt. Ltd.	www.dopodasia.com
Imate	Fourth Generation Mobiles Pvt. Ltd.	NA
LG	LG Electronics India (Pvt.) Ltd.	www.lgindia.com
Motorola	Motorola India	www.motorola.com
Nokia	Nokia India	www.nokia.com
O2	O2	www.seeO2.com
RIM (Blackberry)	Available with select Hutch and Airtel outlet	www.blackberry.com
Samsung	Samsung Telecommunications India	in.samsungmobile.com
Sony Ericsson	Sony Ericsson Mobile Communications (India) Pvt Ltd	www.sonyericsson.com